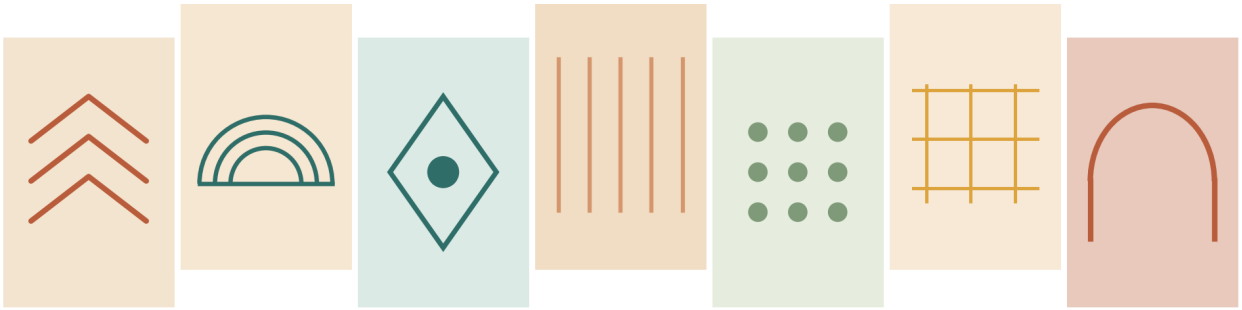


PEACEBUILDING NATIONAL YOUTH DESIGN CHALLENGE 2026

Culture Swap Wall

Where cultures meet, story by story.

PROJECT REPORT

A safe, inclusive digital wall for sharing cultural stories, greetings, food, music, art and everyday life.

Primary theme: Digital Peacebuilding · Secondary theme: Bridging Cultural Divides

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October 2026 · Australia

Executive Summary

Table 1. Culture Swap Wall at a glance

Element	Summary
Problem	Students avoid sharing culture online because they fear judgement, stereotyping and hostile comments; general platforms reward attention rather than understanding.
Primary users	Secondary students aged about 12-16, including students from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds; teachers as supervising adults.
Solution	A curated wall of culture tiles with context, image and audio, search and filters, structured respectful response, and layered human moderation.
Distinctive idea	The Culture Bridge: Discover, Understand, Connect — a guided sequence that requires understanding before it invites a response.
Peacebuilding value	Practice in perspective-taking, respectful communication and inclusion, at a scale schools can supervise.
Status	Design report complete; first prototype tested informally; interactive website rebuild and structured testing still to come.

Culture Swap Wall is a proposed online space where young people can share small, specific pieces of culture — a greeting, a recipe, a song, a celebration, a memory of an ordinary day — and where other young people can encounter those pieces with enough context to understand them. Many students are interested in other cultures but reluctant to speak about their own, because they have seen cultural difference turned into a joke, a stereotype or a target. The original Design Thinking work recorded fear of judgement, bullying, misunderstanding and offensive comments as the central barriers to respectful cultural exchange online. This report keeps that problem at its centre and develops the response in more depth.

The primary audience is secondary-school students aged approximately 12 to 16, including students from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds who want to share their culture without being made into a representative of it. Teachers are a secondary audience: they need a supervised space that connects to Humanities and English without becoming another unmoderated feed.

The solution builds on the original concept: a grid of culture tiles, each opening into a story with images, audio and context; category filters and search; a report control; a moderator queue; and a kindness reminder. This report adds a structured interaction sequence called the Culture Bridge, which moves a visitor from discovering a story, to understanding its context, to connecting through a respectful question or reflection rather than an open comment box. The design deliberately slows the moment between seeing and speaking, because that moment is where most online harm begins.

The intended peacebuilding outcome is modest but meaningful: more confident, respectful conversation about cultural difference; greater recognition of generalisations; and a stronger sense that their own culture has a legitimate place in public. A website cannot remove racism or prejudice. It can, however, make a different kind of interaction feel normal, and give teachers a concrete way to practise it.

The project is at an early stage. A first prototype was built and shown to testers, and the recorded feedback shaped a set of improvements. That evidence is thin: one tester, Arnold, is quoted directly; the other testing is not documented in enough detail to support strong claims. This report therefore separates what was recorded from what was researched and what is proposed. The next phase is a rebuilt, testable website, followed by supervised usability and safety testing with appropriate consent.

A Note on Evidence, Scope and Terminology

This report is built from three different kinds of material, and it matters that a reader can tell them apart. The first is the student's own Design Thinking work, recorded in the original document: the empathy interviews and observations, the ideation activities, the prototype features, and the feedback attributed to Arnold. That material is reported as recorded, including where it is incomplete. The second is external research, cited in the text and listed in the references. It is used to test and strengthen the project's assumptions, not to replace the student's evidence. The third is design proposal: features, sequences and evaluation methods developed in this report. These are clearly labelled as proposed and have not been validated with users.

Three conventions are used throughout.

- **Recorded —** information that appears in the original document. It is preserved even where it is informal, and it is not presented as stronger evidence than it is.
- **Researched —** a claim supported by a published source. Where sources measure different things, the difference is stated rather than smoothed over.
- **Proposed —** a design decision or evaluation method recommended in this report. Proposed material is a hypothesis to be tested, not a result.

Two terminology issues in the original document have been resolved. The client is recorded as "Youth Agents"; the organisation running the challenge is Young Change Agents, and that name is used here. The supplied prototype screenshot carries the working title "CultureShare". The project is called Culture Swap Wall throughout this report, and the screenshot in Appendix E is reproduced with its original title so the evidence remains honest. A final submission should use one name consistently everywhere.

No interviews, quotations, statistics or testing results have been invented. Where the original document says that something was tested but does not record who took part or what they said, the report says so. Where a claim would need evidence the project does not yet have, the claim is framed as an expectation or a question for future testing. The competition's published judging criteria could not be verified, so this report does not invent a rubric. It follows the published challenge requirements — a project page, a visual representation of the idea, and evidence of the design process — and it is organised so that a judge can find the problem, the users, the solution and the evidence quickly (Young Change Agents [YCA], 2026a).

> **WHY THIS NOTE IS IN THE REPORT**
>
> Competition entries are read by people who can tell the difference between a real design process and a polished story. Being precise about what is known, what is assumed and what is still to be tested is not a weakness in the submission; it is evidence that the designer understands their own project.

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1. Introduction and Project Context

Australia is one of the most culturally diverse countries in the world, and young people encounter that diversity daily: in classrooms, in sport, in group chats, in the videos they watch and in the comments under them. The challenge brief describes a country of hundreds of cultures, languages and stories, and frames peacebuilding as more than the absence of conflict. It is "the presence of understanding, fairness, connection, and respect" (YCA, 2026a). That definition matters for this project. Culture Swap Wall is not designed to stop a war or resolve a longstanding community dispute. It is designed to work on the smaller, more common moment in which a young person decides whether to share something of their culture, and whether to respond kindly to someone else's.

That moment is not neutral. The original Design Thinking work found that students were often afraid of being judged or made fun of because of their culture, and that some did not know how to share their culture in a respectful way. Others wanted a fun and easy way to learn about cultures but did not have a space that felt safe enough to try. These findings are consistent with broader evidence about young people's online experience. The challenge brief reports that one in three students experience bullying during their school years, and that almost half of young Australians say they have seen someone treated unfairly because of their background (eSafety Commissioner, 2023, and Scanlon Foundation, 2023, both as cited in YCA, 2026a). National data also show that negative online experiences are common: 44 per cent of 12-17-year-olds surveyed in 2020 reported at least one negative online experience in the previous six months (Australian Institute of Health and Welfare [AIHW], 2021). These figures measure different things and should not be added together, but together they establish that the problem is ordinary, not rare.

Why an online platform? Cultural exchange already happens face to face in schools, but it depends on curriculum time, confident teachers and the willingness of students to speak in front of a room. A well-designed online wall can lower the cost of participation in several specific ways. It is asynchronous, so a student can compose a story at home rather than perform it live. It can hold images and audio, which the original research found helped people feel more connected than text alone. It can be curated, so the first thing a visitor sees is not whatever an algorithm predicts will hold attention. And it can be supervised by an adult with a clear moderation role, which a public social platform cannot offer a school.

The project sits within two of the five challenge themes. Its primary theme is Digital Peacebuilding: "How might we design tools, spaces, or systems that make the digital world safer, more inclusive, and more supportive for young people?" Its secondary theme is Bridging Cultural Divides: reducing racism and prejudice by promoting empathy and positive interaction (YCA, 2026a). The two are connected. A digital space that is safer and more inclusive is also a place where positive cross-cultural interaction can happen; and positive interaction is one of the few things that has been shown, on average, to reduce prejudice.

The project also has a clear curriculum connection. The original document identifies Humanities and Social Sciences and English as relevant learning areas, and the Australian Curriculum describes students as both media consumers and media creators, with media literacy opportunities across English, Media Arts and Digital Technologies (Australian Curriculum, Assessment and Reporting Authority [ACARA], 2022). Culture Swap Wall can be used as a writing task, a HASS inquiry into culture and identity, or a media literacy case study about how a platform's design shapes the way people speak to each other.

1.1 What the project is — and what it is not

Culture Swap Wall is a curated wall, not an infinite feed. Its unit is a culture tile: a small, specific story with an image, an optional audio recording and a short context card. The wall is organised by categories — Food, Music, Greeting, Art, Celebration and Everyday Life — and can be searched. Every tile carries a report control. Nothing appears on the wall until it has passed an automated check and a human review.

It is not a museum of facts about countries, and it is not a place where students are asked to represent an entire culture. The design assumes that cultures are internal, contested and lived in different ways by different people. A single story about one family's New Year celebration is valuable precisely because it is one family's story, not because it stands for everyone who shares that heritage. This distinction is central to the ethics of the project and is discussed further in Section 10.

It is also not a finished product. At the time of writing, the design work and the report are complete; a first prototype has been built and shown to testers; and a new interactive website is the next stage of the work. The report is written so that a reader can see exactly where the evidence stops.

2. Client Requirements and Project Objectives

The original document records the client as "Youth Agents" and lists four requirements: spread cultural ideas, find creative ways to do so, use technology, and provide a safe space for sharing culture online. It names culturally and linguistically diverse (CALD) communities, learners, school students and teachers as the audience, describes the tone as "colourful, expressive", and names Facebook, Instagram, YouTube and Twitter as competitors.

Those requirements are a starting point, not a brief that can be evaluated. "Spread cultural ideas" does not say what success looks like; "safe" does not say who decides what safe means. The table below restates each requirement as an objective with a design response and an evaluation method, so that the project can be judged against something more specific than good intentions. The objectives are deliberately modest: they describe what a small, school-based platform can attempt.

Table 2. Client requirements translated into assessable objectives

Requirement (as recorded)	Objective	Why it matters	Design response	How success could be evaluated
Spread cultural ideas through technology	O1. Enable students to share a specific cultural story in under five minutes.	A platform that is difficult to contribute to will be read, not used.	Tile-based submission form, image and audio upload, plain-language prompts, preview before posting.	Task completion rate and time on task in a supervised usability test.
Creative and innovative methods	O2. Offer a form of cultural exchange that is not simply a feed.	The project needs a reason to exist beside Instagram and YouTube.	Curated wall, context cards, Culture Bridge sequence, audio greetings, classroom mode.	Comparison task: can users explain how the wall differs from a feed? Interview responses.
Provide a safe space	O3. Reduce the likelihood and impact of hostile or demeaning content.	Fear of judgement was the strongest barrier recorded in the empathy work.	Automated pre-check, human moderation, report control, kindness reminder, no direct messages.	Perceived-safety ratings; moderation log; count of harmful posts reaching the wall.
Reach CALD communities, learners and school students	O4. Make the wall usable by students with different languages, abilities and devices.	A platform that only works for confident, fluent, well-connected users reproduces the problem.	Plain language, transcripts, alt text, keyboard access, low-bandwidth mode, translation plan.	Accessibility audit against WCAG 2.2 AA; testing with a screen reader; comprehension checks.
Colourful, expressive tone	O5. Feel warm and welcoming without becoming childish or visually noisy.	Tone affects whether students trust the space enough to contribute.	Warm palette, generous spacing, hand-made tile imagery, restrained motion.	Visual preference and trust ratings from users; structured critique against the brief.
Regular updates on social media and the website	O6. Maintain a visible, trustworthy presence during a pilot.	An empty or stale wall signals that nobody is there.	Seeded classroom content, scheduled spotlight stories, term-based update cycle.	Content calendar completion; returning-visitor rate; teacher feedback.
Compete with general social platforms	O7. Offer a credible alternative for a specific task, not a replacement for social media.	The project cannot out-scale Instagram and should not pretend to.	Position as a classroom and community tool with curation and care built in.	Teacher willingness to reuse it; proportion of users who return within a term.

2.1 Constraints the design must respect

The objectives sit inside real constraints: no budget, no engineering team, a fixed competition deadline in early November 2026 (YCA, 2026a), and participants who are minors. The project also depends on adults to moderate content, and it cannot guarantee safety. The design response is to stay small, supervised and honest about its limits rather than claim protection it cannot deliver.

3. Problem Identification and Research

The original document names the problem in one line: modern social media platforms can be filled with misinformation and disinformation, and the note ends with "need more". The empathy work goes further. It records fear of being bullied, stereotypes and misunderstandings, mean comments, limited knowledge of other cultures and nervousness about posting online. This section turns those notes into a defined problem, tests them against published evidence, and explains why existing platforms do not fully meet the need.

3.1 What the original work identified

Five barriers recur in the original document. First, fear of judgement: students worried that sharing their culture would make them a target. Second, stereotyping: students had seen cultures reduced to a joke or a single story. Third, bullying and offensive comments: the behaviour itself, not only the fear of it. Fourth, misunderstanding: students did not always know enough about a culture to respond well, and were embarrassed to ask. Fifth, a skills gap: some students did not know how to share their culture in a respectful way, which is different from not wanting to.

These are plausible and internally consistent, but they come from a small piece of qualitative work. The original document does not record how many students were interviewed, how they were selected, what questions were asked, or how the observations were recorded. That does not make the findings wrong. It does mean they should be treated as hypotheses with a strong starting point, not as a prevalence study. The distinction shapes the research question for the next phase: the project does not need to prove that every student is afraid; it needs to understand which students are, in which situations, and what would make a difference.

3.2 What the published evidence adds

The broader evidence supports the direction of the original findings while making the scale and the limits of the problem clearer. Bullying is common but not universal. In Mission Australia's 2019 survey, 21 per cent of respondents aged 15-19 reported being bullied in the previous year, and 37 per cent of those who reported bullying said it included cyberbullying (AIHW, 2021). Those are not the same as saying that 37 per cent of young people are cyberbullied; the base is different, and the report is careful about it. A separate 2020 survey found that 44 per cent of 12-17-year-olds had experienced at least one negative online experience in the previous six months, a broader measure that includes exposure to upsetting content as well as interpersonal harm (AIHW, 2021).

Cultural identity adds a specific dimension. In longitudinal Australian data, 31 per cent of teenagers who spoke a language other than English at home reported experiencing racial discrimination between the ages of 12 and 17, compared with 19 per cent of all teenagers (Australian Institute of Family Studies [AIFS], 2021). That measure is about perceived discrimination in general, not online racism specifically, and it should not be described as an online figure. It does show that cultural background changes the risk profile of a young person's social world. Research with young Asian Australians during the pandemic found that exposure to anti-Asian content online was common among respondents, with 36.3 per cent reporting exposure "sometimes", 15.5 per cent "often" and 5.1 per cent "all the time" (Melbourne Asia Review, 2021). The sample was self-selected, included adults up to 30 and was collected in a particular moment, so it is indicative rather than representative. It is still a useful corrective to the idea that online racism is an abstract concern.

A qualitative study of African Australian young people offers a different kind of insight. Gatwiri and Moran (2023) describe young people using social media to name anti-Black racism, assert identity and build communities of belonging. Their account matters for this project because it treats young people as agents, not only as potential victims. A platform that only protects users and never lets them speak will miss the point. The design goal is not to shield students from cultural difference; it is to give them a safer way to engage with it.

> **READING THE EVIDENCE CAREFULLY**
>
> The figures above measure bullying, negative online experiences, perceived discrimination and exposure to racist content. They are not interchangeable. This report does not combine them into a single prevalence rate, and it does not claim that they describe the students in this project's own school. They establish that the problem is credible and that cultural identity is part of it.

3.3 Why general social platforms do not fully meet the need

It would be inaccurate to say that Facebook, Instagram, YouTube or Twitter are simply unsafe. Each hosts communities that are thoughtful, creative and supportive, and each has improved its tools for reporting and restricting harmful content. The argument in this report is narrower: general platforms are optimised for a different job. Their business model rewards attention, and attention is often best captured by content that provokes strong reactions. Their default unit is the public post with an open comment field and visible popularity metrics. Those choices are reasonable for a general network and poorly suited to a classroom conversation about culture, where the goal is understanding rather than reach.

Moderation is the second structural gap. Automated systems can detect some clearly abusive language, but they struggle with context, dialect, humour, reclaimed language and cultural reference. New America's analysis of automated moderation explains that hate speech is especially difficult because meaning depends on community and region, and because training data is uneven across languages and dialects; automated decisions produce both false positives and false negatives (New America, 2019). A school needs a process that can recognise the difference between a student quoting a stereotype in order to criticise it and a student repeating it as a joke. That is a human judgement, made by someone who knows the context and can follow up with the students involved.

The third gap is scale and relationship. A general platform cannot know that the student who posted a dismissive comment sits two rows behind the student whose family celebration was mocked. A teacher can. The design opportunity is therefore not to build a better global network. It is to build a small, supervised space where the social context is visible and where an adult can act on it.

3.4 Documented findings, working hypotheses and open questions

The project's evidence base becomes more useful when it is sorted. The table below separates what the original work recorded, what this report treats as a working hypothesis, and what still needs to be investigated. The open questions are not a weakness; they are the agenda for the testing described in Section 9.

Table 3. Evidence status of the project's key claims

Claim	Status	Basis	What would strengthen it
Students fear judgement when sharing culture online	Recorded finding	Original empathy interviews and observations	A short anonymous survey with a defined sample; interviews with students who have never posted.
Students do not always know how to share culture respectfully	Recorded finding	Original empathy work	Task-based testing of draft stories; analysis of where submissions go wrong.
Audio and images increase connection	Recorded insight, not tested	Original empathy work; design intuition	A/B comparison of text-only and media-rich stories; user interviews.
A structured prompt reduces hostile comments	Working hypothesis	Reasoning from moderation research; not yet tested	Comment-quality comparison between open and scaffolded response; moderation log.
A curated wall increases perceived safety	Working hypothesis	Design reasoning	Perceived-safety scale before and after use; interviews.
Digital contact can reduce prejudice	Researched, with limits	Meta-analysis of 88 samples (da Costa et al., 2024)	Not provable by this project; use as a rationale for interaction design, not a promised outcome.

3.5 Problem statement and design question

The problem statement below develops the original statement without changing its meaning. It names the users, the task, the barrier and the consequence.

> **PROBLEM STATEMENT**
>
> Young people, especially students from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds, have cultural stories they are willing to share but often choose not to, because online spaces expose them to stereotyping, mockery and hostile comments, and because they do not always have the language or the confidence to describe their culture in a way that feels accurate. The result is a double loss: students do not see their own culture reflected respectfully, and they do not develop the understanding of other cultures that peaceful coexistence requires.

The design question follows the challenge's guidance that a "How might we" statement should not contain its own solution (YCA, 2026a). It focuses on the behaviour the project wants to change rather than the feature it wants to build.

> **DESIGN QUESTION**
>
> How might we help young people move from seeing a culture to understanding it, and from understanding it to speaking about it respectfully — in a space where they feel safe enough to contribute?

The question sets up the rest of the report. "Seeing" is the easy part; most platforms already show culture. "Understanding" requires context and a reason to slow down. "Speaking respectfully" requires scaffolding, norms and a consequence structure. "Safe enough to contribute" requires moderation, privacy and a believable promise that a student's story will not be turned against them. Each of these requirements maps onto a design decision in Sections 7 to 10.

4. Empathise

The Design Thinking process begins with empathy because a solution built from assumptions tends to solve the designer's problem rather than the user's. The original document describes the empathise stage as an attempt to see the platform from the point of view of the people who would use it, and to understand what makes it hard for them to share their culture online. That purpose is sound. This section keeps the original material, adds the context needed to interpret it, and sets out a more rigorous plan for collecting evidence in the next phase.

The design thinking literature describes empathy as observing users, engaging them and immersing oneself in their experience in order to understand needs that may not be articulated (Brown, 2008). For a student designer, that does not mean claiming to know what it feels like to belong to a particular cultural group. It means listening carefully, noticing what people avoid as well as what they say, and being explicit about the limits of one's own perspective.

4.1 Who the project empathised with

The original document identifies five groups. They are retained here because they represent genuinely different relationships to the problem, and because a single platform has to work for all of them.

- **Students from different cultural backgrounds.** They are the primary sharers. Their need is not simply to be represented but to control how they are represented, and to avoid becoming the spokesperson for a whole culture.
- **People who have been stereotyped or misunderstood because of their culture.** They carry the strongest reason to avoid public posting. Their experience sets the safety bar for the platform.
- **Students who are nervous about sharing their culture online.** They may want to participate but lack confidence, language or a safe entry point. They are the group most likely to be lost by a design that assumes confidence.
- **Teachers who want a safe place for students to talk about culture.** They need control, visibility and a defensible process. Without them, the platform cannot be used in a school.
- **Young people who already use TikTok, Instagram and Discord.** They bring expectations about how a digital space should look and behave, and they will judge the wall against those expectations.

Two further groups are relevant but were not named in the original work: parents and caregivers, who may need to understand what is published and how it is moderated; and school leaders, who carry duty-of-care responsibilities. They are treated as secondary audiences in this report and are not used to justify design decisions without evidence.

4.2 Methods used

The original document records three methods: interviews with students about how they feel when sharing their culture online; observation of how people interact during events; and observation of behaviour in online group chats. These are appropriate methods for an early-stage project. Interviews can surface language and stories that a survey would flatten; observation can reveal what people do rather than what they say they do.

They also have limitations that should be stated plainly. The document does not record how many students were interviewed, how they were chosen, whether they consented, what questions were asked, or how the observations were captured. Observation of group chats raises privacy questions even when the observer is a participant. And the observer's interpretation is shaped by their own cultural position. None of this

invalidates the findings, but it limits how far they can be generalised. A stronger version of the same methods would use a short, agreed interview guide; a defined group of participants; anonymised notes; and a simple coding process that groups comments into themes.

The original document also does not record any secondary research. This report adds it, in Section 3, so that the project's findings can be compared with what is already known. That comparison strengthens the original insights rather than replacing them.

4.3 What the empathy work found

Six insights are recorded in the original document. Each is restated below with its design implication, because an insight that does not change a decision is only an observation.

- **Fear of judgement is the main barrier.** Students are not primarily worried about the technology; they are worried about the audience. Design implication: reduce exposure. No public follower counts, no direct messages, no ranking of stories, and a clear statement of who can see what.
- **Some students do not know how to share culture respectfully.** This is a skills problem, not a motivation problem. Design implication: provide structure. Prompts, examples and a preview step do more than a warning message.
- **Students want learning about culture to be fun and easy.** Curiosity is the entry point. Design implication: lead with a striking image or a 20-second sound, then offer depth for those who want it.
- **Students need a place free from bullying and offence.** Safety is a precondition, not a feature. Design implication: moderation and reporting must be visible before a student is asked to contribute.
- **Audio and images help people feel connected.** Voice carries tone, accent and personality in a way text does not. Design implication: make audio a first-class format, with transcripts for accessibility.
- **Simple designs are better than complicated ones.** Cognitive load is a barrier for younger users, multilingual users and users on small screens. Design implication: one clear action per screen, plain language, generous spacing.

One insight deserves more attention than the original document gives it: students may want to share their culture but not know what counts as "culture". School projects often treat culture as festivals, food and national dress, which can make everyday life invisible and push students towards performance. The original document's inclusion of "Everyday Life" as a category is therefore important. It signals that a family's ordinary dinner, the way a grandmother answers the phone, or the slang a student uses with cousins are legitimate cultural material. This broadens participation beyond students who have a spectacular story to tell.

Table 4. User groups, needs and design responses

User group	Primary need	Related insight	Design response	Evidence status
CALD students who want to share	Control over representation; safety from mockery	Fear of judgement; stereotyping	No public metrics, pseudonyms allowed, context fields written by the author, report control	Recorded insight; response proposed
Students who are nervous	A low-risk way to participate	Skills gap; fear of judgement	Reflection and question prompts; no requirement to post a story to take part	Recorded insight; response proposed
Students learning about other cultures	Context, not just content	Misunderstanding; curiosity	Context cards, category filters, Culture Bridge sequence	Recorded insight; response proposed
Teachers	Visibility, control and a defensible process	Need for a safe space	Moderator dashboard, audit log, class code, community rules	Recorded need; response proposed
Frequent social media users	Familiarity without the harms	Existing platform habits	Recognisable tile grid and filters, but no infinite scroll or follower counts	Inferred; needs testing

4.4 Collecting further evidence ethically

The next round of empathy work should be planned, not improvised. A short interview guide with six to eight open questions would be enough: Can you tell me about a time you shared something about your culture online? What happened? What made it easy or hard? What would you want people to understand about your culture? What would make you feel safe enough to post? Who would you not want to see it? What would you want to be able to remove? These questions invite stories rather than ratings, and they do not ask a student to explain their entire culture.

Participation should be voluntary, with written consent from the student and, where required, a parent or caregiver. Students should be able to skip questions, stop at any time and withdraw their data before analysis. Notes should be anonymised at the point of collection, stored in a secure place and not shared with other students. The interviewer should avoid asking students to speak on behalf of a cultural group, and should be alert to distress. If a student discloses bullying or harm, the interviewer should follow the school's wellbeing and reporting procedures rather than trying to manage it alone. These are standard research-ethics practices, and they matter more than usual when the participants are minors and the topic is identity.

4.5 What the empathy stage changed

The empathy work changed the project in three ways. It moved the design from a general platform for sharing culture to a safety-first space for a specific kind of sharing: small, contextual and authored. It added features that exist only because users said they were afraid — pseudonyms, no public follower counts, a visible report control and a reminder before posting. And it changed the project's central question from "how do we get students to post?" to "what would make posting feel worth the risk?"

That second question is harder to design for, because it cannot be answered with a feature list. It requires the platform to earn trust: by explaining who can see a story, by showing what happens after a report, and by demonstrating that the adults in the space will act. The prototype tested the visual warmth of the wall. The next round has to test whether the wall feels trustworthy enough to use.

5. Define

The Define stage turns empathy into a design target. The original document moves from a broad problem statement to a list of requirements: the platform must be safe, must have rules, must be easy to use, must be fun and visual, must encourage kindness and must celebrate cultures. Those requirements are a good starting point because they describe qualities rather than features. This section sharpens them into a problem definition that a designer can actually test.

5.1 The problem, stated for design

The primary users are secondary-school students aged approximately 12 to 16 who have a cultural story they might share and who do not feel confident that sharing it will be safe. Their most important needs are safety from mockery, control over how their culture is represented, a low-effort way to contribute, and a reason to believe that other users will respond with curiosity rather than judgement. The main barriers are fear of judgement, limited knowledge of other cultures, uncertainty about what to say, and the design of existing platforms, which reward attention and make hostile comments easy and visible.

The design opportunity is not to build a bigger social network. It is to build a small, curated space where the sequence of interaction is intentionally different: context comes before comment, response is scaffolded, and an adult is present. The solution does not need to make every student post. It needs to make the first respectful exchange likely enough that a second one can happen.

5.2 Design criteria

The original document's six "must" statements are retained and converted into criteria that can be assessed. Each criterion has a test, because a criterion without a test is a slogan.

Table 5. Design criteria and how each would be assessed

Criterion	What it means in practice	How it would be assessed
Safe	Harmful content is unlikely to reach the wall, and users can act quickly when it does.	Moderation log; number and resolution time of reports; perceived-safety ratings.
Rule-governed	Community expectations are visible, specific and consistently enforced.	Comprehension check with users; consistency audit of moderator decisions.
Easy to use	A first-time user can find and open a story without instructions.	Task success rate and time on task; observation of first use.
Fun and visual	The wall invites exploration and feels good to use.	Short engagement and enjoyment ratings; interview comments.
Kind	The interface prompts respectful response before it allows a reaction.	Quality of comments against a rubric; proportion of responses that add context or a question.
Culturally celebratory	Stories are specific, contextual and presented as one person's experience.	Content audit for specificity and consent; feedback from cultural advisers.
Accessible	Users with different abilities, devices and language levels can take part.	WCAG 2.2 AA audit; screen-reader and keyboard testing; plain-language review.

The criteria conflict in predictable ways, and the conflicts are design decisions rather than problems to be avoided. Safety and openness pull against each other: every moderation rule reduces some harmful speech and some legitimate speech. Ease of use and depth pull against each other: a context card that genuinely explains a celebration takes longer to read than a caption. Fun and seriousness pull against each other: the wall should feel warm without making culture into entertainment. The project's position is that safety and

understanding take priority over reach and speed, because those are the qualities that distinguish it from the platforms it is trying to improve on.

5.3 Why this matters for peacebuilding

Peacebuilding is often imagined as a response to large-scale conflict. For young people in a diverse school, it more often looks like the daily work of not turning a difference into a insult, and of being willing to ask a question instead of assuming an answer. The Define stage matters for peacebuilding because it decides what the platform is for. If the goal were engagement, the design would optimise for time on site and reactions. If the goal is understanding, the design optimises for context, reflection and respectful exchange — even if that means fewer interactions. That choice is the project's ethical starting point, and every later decision follows from it.

5.4 Design principles that follow from the definition

Five principles follow from the definition and the criteria. They are stated here because they are the tests the later sections keep returning to.

1. **Safety before sharing.** A student should never have to choose between participating and feeling safe. If a feature makes sharing easier but increases exposure, it is rejected.
2. **Context before comment.** Understanding should come before response. The interface should make the story legible before it invites a reaction.
3. **Human judgement at the edges.** Automation can triage; people should decide. Ambiguous cases need a reviewer who knows the context and can follow up.
4. **Small is a feature.** A class-sized wall is easier to moderate, more likely to feel safe and more realistic to sustain than a school-wide or national platform.
5. **Accessible by default.** If the wall does not work for the least confident user — the student with a screen reader, a slow connection or limited English — it does not work.

6. Ideate

The Ideate stage is where the project generated more ideas than it could use. The original document records five techniques: Crazy 8s, mind mapping, asking "How might we…?" questions, drawing sketches, and brainstorming with a group. It then lists fourteen ideas and six final choices. This section keeps that process visible, explains the purpose of each idea, and makes the selection reasoning explicit. The aim is not to make the process look tidy. It is to show that the final feature set was chosen rather than assumed.

6.1 How the ideas were generated

Crazy 8s is a time-boxed sketching activity in which a designer folds a page into eight sections and draws eight different solutions in eight minutes. Its value is not the quality of any single sketch; it is that the first few obvious ideas are used up quickly, forcing less obvious ones to appear. Mind mapping works in the opposite direction, starting from a central concept — in this case "sharing culture" — and branching into formats, audiences, barriers and feelings. The "How might we" questions reframe a problem as an opportunity, and group brainstorming adds ideas that a single designer would not reach.

The original document records five "How might we" questions: How might we make sharing culture fun? How might we stop mean posts? How might we encourage kindness? How might we make culture easy to explore? How might we use audio to help people connect? The last question is noticeably narrower than the others because it contains its own solution. The challenge guidance is explicit that a "How might we" statement should not include the solution, because doing so closes off other possibilities (YCA, 2026a). A stronger version would be: How might we help people feel a culture's atmosphere, not just read about it? Audio then becomes one possible answer among several, alongside video, soundscapes, recipes and object stories.

This is a small but useful lesson from the ideation stage: the quality of the question shapes the range of the answer. The project uses three broad questions to organise its thinking — one about participation, one about safety, and one about understanding — and treats specific formats as answers rather than premises.

6.2 The ideas and what each was for

The fourteen ideas in the original document are not a random list. They cluster into four purposes, and naming those purposes makes the later selection easier to justify.

Table 6. Ideas generated, grouped by purpose

Purpose	Ideas from the original document	What the idea was trying to achieve
Make culture visible and explorable	A grid of culture tiles; pop-up stories; an interactive map of cultures; a daily culture spotlight; a random culture generator; a celebration calendar	Give a visitor somewhere to start, and make exploration feel like wandering through a mural rather than scrolling a feed.
Carry tone and personality	Audio greetings; an audio player for cultural sounds	Let voice, accent, music and ambient sound communicate what text cannot, and reduce the pressure to write perfect English.
Support specific kinds of story	A section for food stories; a gallery for art and clothing	Give structure to contributions and signal that everyday culture, not only festivals, is welcome.
Keep the space safe	Safe upload filters; a report button; a queue for moderators; a reminder to be kind before posting	Prevent harm before it reaches the wall, and give users and moderators a clear response when it does.

Two observations follow from the grouping. First, the original ideas are strong on discovery and weak on interaction: most of them help a visitor look at culture, but only the comment field — implied rather than designed — helps them respond to it. That gap is the reason the Culture Bridge is the main addition in this report. Second, the safety ideas are all procedural (filters, reports, queues, reminders). Procedures are necessary but they do not teach anyone how to speak. A platform that only blocks bad behaviour relies on users already knowing what good behaviour looks like.

6.3 Selecting the features

Six features were chosen in the original document: culture tiles, support for images and audio, a moderation system, a report button, a kindness reminder, and six culture categories. The selection is sound, but the original document does not explain why other ideas were left out. The matrix below makes the reasoning transparent. Each candidate was rated from 1 (weak) to 3 (strong) against six criteria: peacebuilding value, user safety, ease of use, feasibility within the project's constraints, accessibility, and distinctiveness from existing platforms.

The ratings are design judgements, not measured results. They represent the designer's assessment against the brief at the time of writing. A different designer could reasonably rate them differently, and the purpose of the table is to expose the reasoning so that it can be challenged, not to claim precision that does not exist.

Table 7. Feature-selection matrix (1 = weak, 3 = strong; design judgement)

Candidate feature	Peace	Safety	Ease	Feasible	Access	Distinct	Total	Decision
Culture tiles with context cards	3	3	3	3	3	3	18	Build
Images and audio with transcripts	3	2	2	3	2	3	15	Build
Category filters and search	2	3	3	3	3	2	16	Build
Human moderation and reporting	3	3	2	2	3	3	16	Build
Kindness reminder and response prompts	3	3	3	3	3	3	18	Build
Culture Bridge sequence	3	3	2	3	2	3	16	Build
Interactive map of cultures	2	2	2	1	1	3	11	Phase 2
Daily spotlight and random generator	2	3	3	2	3	2	15	Phase 2
Celebration calendar	2	3	3	2	2	2	14	Phase 2
Open comment threads	2	1	3	3	2	1	12	Reject
Public likes and follower counts	2	1	3	3	3	1	13	Reject

The matrix produces a clear result. The features that score highest are those that do more than one job: tiles with context support discovery, safety and understanding; response prompts support kindness and peacebuilding at the same time. The interactive map scores lower on feasibility and accessibility, not because it is a bad idea but because a map raises hard questions. Cultures do not map neatly onto borders, diasporic communities would appear in the "wrong" place, and a political map can imply that a culture belongs to a state. It is therefore deferred to a second phase, where it can be designed as a "culture atlas" that combines a map with a list view and treats location as one part of a story rather than its definition.

Open comment threads and public popularity metrics are rejected. Both are standard features of social media, and both reproduce the conditions the project is trying to change. An open comment box invites the fastest response rather than the most thoughtful one. Likes and follower counts turn cultural expression into a competition and give users a number that can be compared. The wall keeps a private, aggregate count for the moderator's eyes only, so that the team can see whether the space is being used, without turning culture into a score.

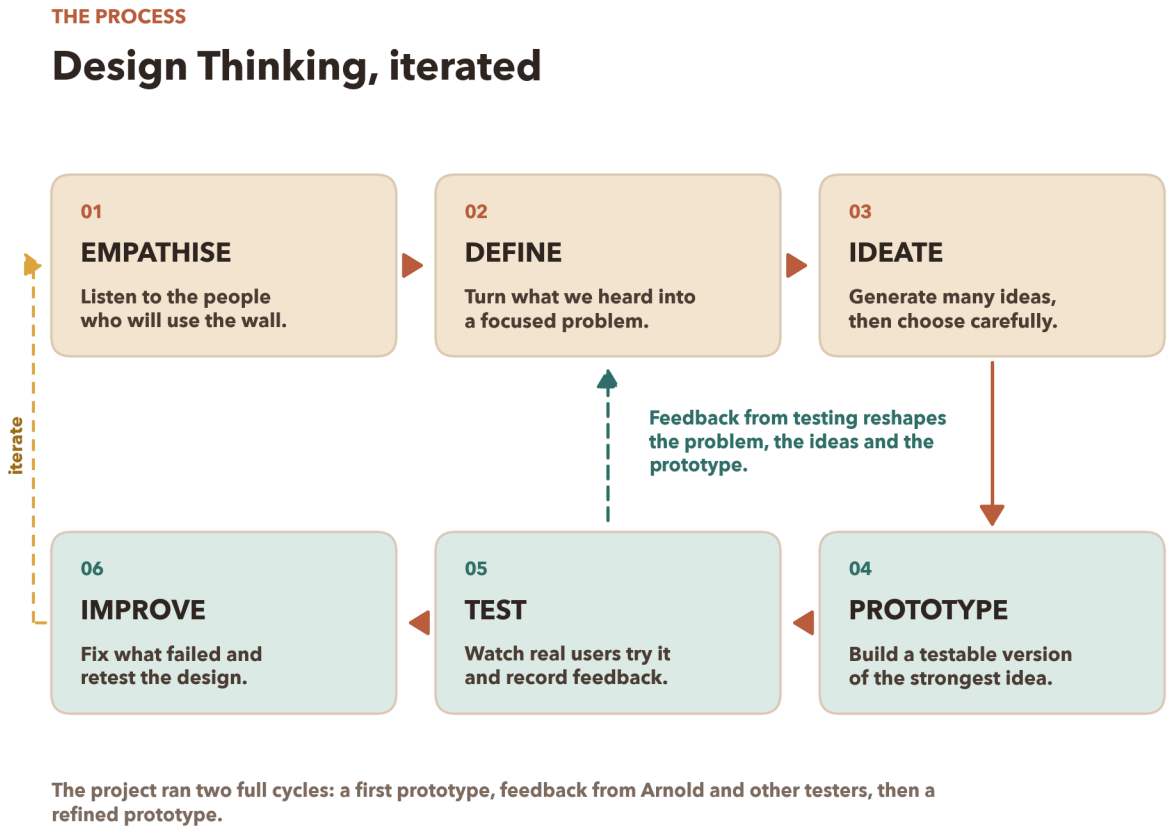


Figure 1. The Design Thinking process as it was actually used. The project moved through two cycles: an initial prototype, feedback from Arnold and other testers, then a refined prototype. The dashed lines show where testing changed earlier decisions rather than only polishing the final screen.

6.4 What the final feature set does

Taken together, the six core features form a coherent system rather than a list. The tiles and categories solve the discovery problem. Images and audio solve the tone problem, allowing a visitor to hear a greeting rather than read a description of it. The kindness reminder and response prompts solve the behaviour problem at the point where behaviour happens. Moderation and reporting solve the consequence problem when prevention fails. The Culture Bridge, described in Section 7, connects them by giving the visitor a next step that is more specific than "comment".

The features that were deferred are not abandoned. A daily spotlight, a celebration calendar and a random story generator would all help a wall feel alive, and a culture atlas would help visitors see connections between stories. They are sequenced after the core because they depend on a supply of moderated content and a moderation team that does not yet exist. Building them first would create an empty, unsafe or unmaintainable space.

6.5 What the selection process revealed

The matrix exposed two tensions that a simple list of ideas would have hidden. The first is between distinctiveness and feasibility: the interactive map was the most distinctive idea in the set, and also the least feasible and the hardest to make accessible. The second is between openness and safety: an open comment thread was the easiest way to let people respond, and the most likely to reproduce the harm the project exists to prevent. In both cases the selection favoured the option that could be moderated, tested and explained, not the option that looked most exciting in a sketch.

The process also revealed a gap. Most of the original ideas helped a visitor look at culture; very few helped them respond to it. The Culture Bridge was added to fill that gap, and it became the project's most distinctive feature. That is a useful lesson about ideation: the missing idea is often not another format, but the step between the formats.

7. Proposed Solution and Distinctive Value

Culture Swap Wall is a curated digital wall of cultural stories. A visitor arrives at a grid of tiles, each carrying an image, a short title, a category and the name or pseudonym of the person who shared it. Opening a tile reveals the story, its context and, where available, an audio recording. A visitor can search, filter by category, and move from a story to a respectful response. Nothing on the wall is published without human review.

The concept builds directly on the original prototype rather than replacing it. The tile grid, the pop-up story, the categories, the audio, the report button and the kindness reminder all come from the original design. What this report adds is a clearer answer to a question the prototype left open: once a visitor has seen a story, what should they do next? The original design implied a comment box. This report replaces that with the Culture Bridge.

7.1 The anatomy of a tile

A tile is deliberately small. It contains an image (or a colour field if the author prefers not to use a photograph), a title of no more than eight words, a category, and a one-line invitation such as "A sound from my grandmother's kitchen". Opening it reveals four layers:

6. **The story.** Two to five sentences in the author's own voice, written in response to prompts rather than a blank box.
7. **The context card.** A short explanation of what the story means, written or approved by the author, including what the author wants a visitor to understand and what they do not want assumed.
8. **The media.** An image with alt text, and optional audio with a transcript. Audio is capped at 60 seconds to keep the form achievable and the wall quick to explore.
9. **The response zone.** A small set of respectful question and reflection prompts, plus a report control. There is no open comment field and no public like count.

The context card is the most important part of the design. It is where the platform distinguishes itself from a content feed. A photograph of a dish without context invites a visitor to consume it; a context card that explains who makes it, when, and what it means turns the same photograph into an invitation to understand. The card also protects the author: it lets them set the terms of interpretation before anyone else responds.

7.2 The Culture Bridge

The Culture Bridge is a three-stage sequence that a visitor can choose after opening a story. It is the project's main proposed enhancement and has not yet been tested with users. Its purpose is to make the movement from seeing to speaking deliberate, and to give a visitor who does not know what to say a respectful way to say something.

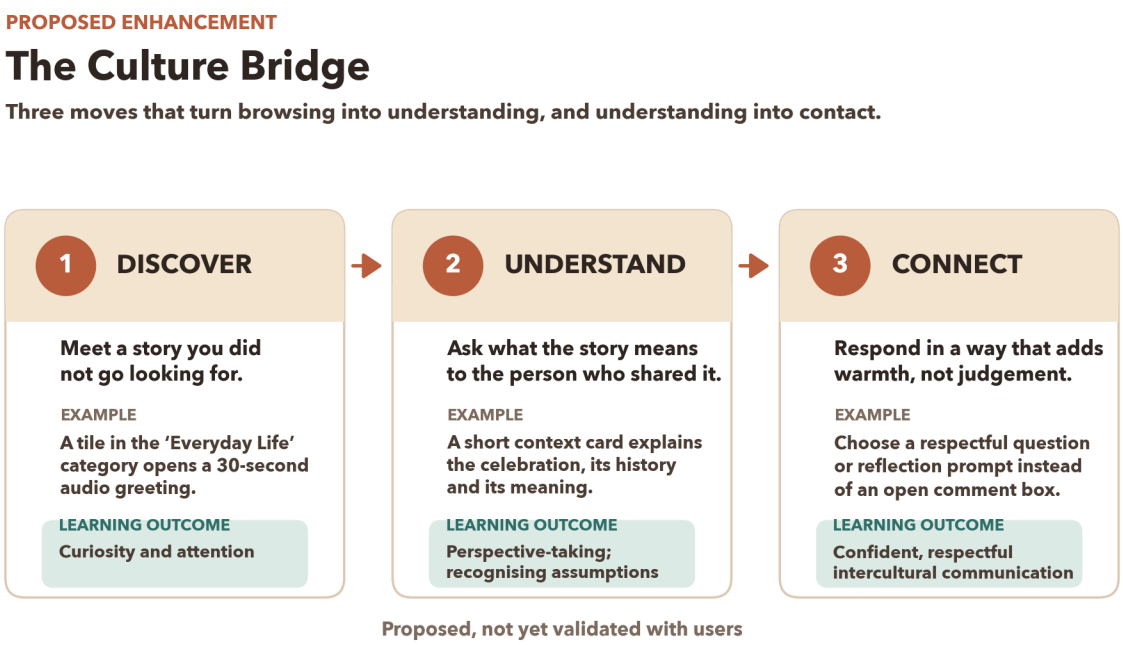


Figure 2. The Culture Bridge. Each stage pairs an example action with the learning outcome it is intended to produce. The sequence is proposed, not yet validated with users.

Table 8. The Culture Bridge in practice

Stage	What the visitor sees	Example prompt	Why the prompt is designed this way
Discover	A tile and its title, with no response controls visible.	"Open a story you would not normally choose."	Separates looking from speaking, so the first action is curiosity rather than reaction.
Understand	The story and context card, with one reflection cue.	"What did you assume before you read this? What changed?"	Invites perspective-taking and makes the visitor's own assumptions visible without shaming them.
Connect	Three response options: ask a question, share a related reflection, or thank the author.	"What would you like to ask the person who shared this?"	Replaces the open comment box with a small set of prosocial moves that are harder to misuse.

The sequence draws on a body of research on intergroup contact, which suggests that positive interaction between groups can reduce prejudice under the right conditions. A meta-analysis of digital intergroup contact found a small but statistically significant reduction in prejudice across 88 samples, with direct contact producing larger effects than indirect contact (da Costa et al., 2024). The finding is modest and the studies vary widely, so it cannot be used to promise that a school platform will change attitudes. It does support a specific design choice: if contact is the mechanism, the platform should facilitate interaction rather than only display content. A wall that is read but never answered is a museum; a wall that invites a respectful question is closer to a conversation.

The sequence also reflects what is known about online harm. Harm often begins with a fast, low-effort response to a decontextualised fragment. Adding a step between seeing and responding does not eliminate that risk, but it changes the default. A visitor who has read a context card and chosen a question is in a different frame of mind from a visitor who has been handed an empty box under a photograph. The design cannot control what a person thinks, but it can shape what the interface makes easy.

7.3 Beyond viewing: what makes the wall different

The original document positions the wall against Facebook, Instagram, YouTube and Twitter. It would be unrealistic to compete with those platforms on scale, features or network effects. The wall competes on a different axis: the quality of a single exchange. The comparison below is deliberately specific, because "kinder than social media" is too vague to guide design.

Table 9. How the wall differs from a general social feed

Dimension	General social feed	Culture Swap Wall
Ordering	Algorithmic, optimised for attention and recency.	Curated and category-based, with a finite wall and no infinite scroll.
Unit of content	A post, often decontextualised and designed for a fast reaction.	A story with a context card, author-set framing and optional audio.
Response	Open comment box, public replies, visible popularity.	A small set of respectful prompts; no public like count; private reflection option.
Audience	Potentially unlimited and unknown.	A class, a school or an invited community; visibility explained before posting.
Moderation	Automated at scale, with limited context and slow appeals.	Automated pre-check plus a named human reviewer who knows the school context.
Purpose	Engagement, connection and advertising.	Understanding, respectful communication and a safe first experience of cultural exchange.

The wall's distinctive value is therefore not a feature that could be copied in a week. It is the combination of a finite, curated collection; an interaction sequence designed for understanding; and a human moderation process embedded in a school. Each element is modest. Together they create a different social contract: the platform is not trying to maximise how much a student posts, but to make the posts that do happen worth reading.

7.4 How the design supports peacebuilding

The project contributes to peacebuilding through four mechanisms, each of which is a hypothesis rather than a proven effect.

- **Perspective-taking.** The context card and the "what did you assume?" prompt ask a visitor to imagine the author's point of view. Perspective-taking is a common component of anti-bias education, although its effects vary by programme and age.
- **Positive contact.** The response prompts create a structured, low-stakes interaction between people who may not otherwise speak. The digital contact literature suggests this can reduce prejudice on average, with small effects (da Costa et al., 2024).
- **Norm-setting.** Visible community rules, kindness reminders and consistent moderation communicate what is normal in this space. Norms are one of the mechanisms through which school-based cyberbullying programmes appear to work, alongside skills training and clear consequences (Gaffney et al., 2019).
- **Voice and recognition.** Allowing students to describe their own culture on their own terms counters the experience of being spoken about. Gatwiri and Moran (2023) show that young people already use social media to assert identity and build belonging; the wall tries to make that easier to do safely.

These mechanisms are plausible, but they are not the same as evidence that this platform produces these outcomes. The evaluation framework in Section 12 is designed to test them rather than assume them.

7.5 Boundaries of the concept

The project is honest about what it cannot do. It cannot resolve a conflict between communities, replace a wellbeing service, or guarantee that no student will ever be hurt. It is not a truth-telling process for First Nations histories, and it should not be presented as one; that work requires community authority, local protocols and a much longer commitment. It is also not a solution to misinformation on the open internet. It is a small, supervised environment in which young people can practise a better kind of conversation. That is a narrow ambition, and it is the right size for the project.

7.6 How the pieces fit together

The platform is best understood as a loop rather than a page. A visitor discovers a tile, reads the context card, chooses a respectful response, and sees their response appear alongside the story. The author receives the response and can reply or remove the story. A moderator sees the exchange, checks that it stayed within the community agreement, and uses what they learn to adjust the prompts or the rules. Each part of the loop makes the next part easier: a good context card produces a better question, a better question produces a response worth reading, and a visible moderation process makes the next student more willing to contribute.

This is why the project measures success differently from a social platform. A feed succeeds when a user stays longer; the wall succeeds when a user understands something and says something respectful. Those outcomes are harder to count, but they are the ones the design is built for. If the wall is used for ten minutes and produces one good question, it has done its job better than a feed that holds attention for an hour and produces nothing.

8. Prototype and Design Decisions

A first prototype of the website was built to test how users would interact with the design. The original document lists its features: a grid of culture tiles; a pop-up window with images and audio; an upload form; a filter to block words; a moderator queue; a report button; placeholder images and audio; and a design with soft colours. The screenshot preserved in Appendix E shows an early version under the working title "CultureShare", with a navigation bar, a hero section, featured story cards and a story detail view with comments. It is a useful record of the concept at an early stage, and it also shows how much of the safety model was still a promise rather than an interface.

8.1 Interface and layout

The prototype's central metaphor is a wall, not a feed. Tiles are arranged in a grid that reads like a mural: different sizes, warm colours, images and short titles. The grid is finite and organised by category, so a visitor can see the whole collection rather than scrolling indefinitely. A filter bar runs across the top, and a search field sits beside it. Opening a tile produces a pop-up rather than a new page, which keeps the visitor's place on the wall and reduces the sense of being pulled into an endless stream. A close control is always visible, because a pop-up that traps the user is a usability failure and, for some users, a distressing one.

The upload form follows the same logic. It asks for a title, a category, a short story, an image and optional audio, then shows a preview before the story is submitted. The preview is not decoration. It lets the author see their story as others will see it, which is the moment when many people decide to remove a detail they are not comfortable sharing. The form also asks for context: what the story means, and what the author would like visitors to understand. That question is what turns an upload into a shareable tile.

The moderator queue is a separate, restricted view. It lists pending stories with their media, flags any automated warnings, and offers three actions: approve, return with a reason, or escalate. The original document lists the queue as a feature but does not describe the interface. The design proposed here keeps it deliberately plain: a moderator working through twenty stories needs consistency and speed, not a rich dashboard.

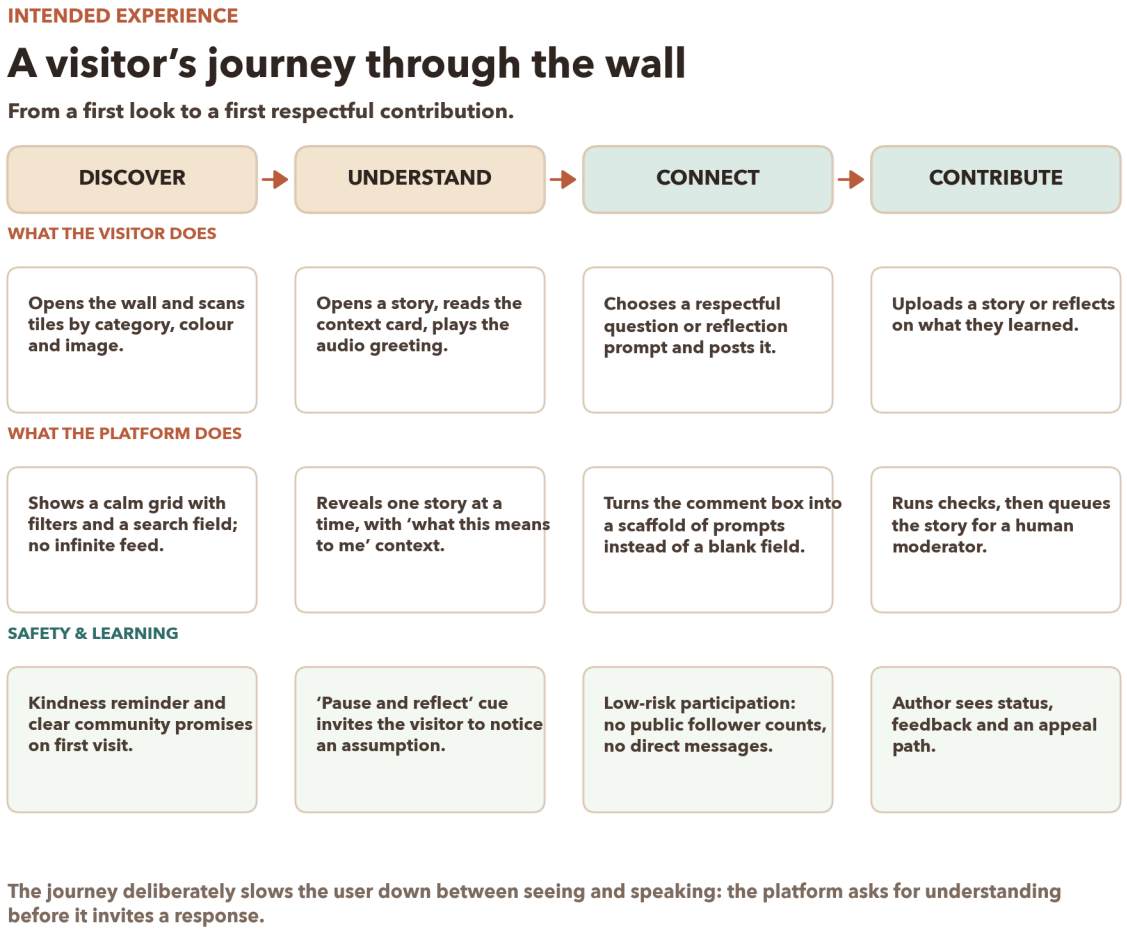


Figure 3. The intended visitor journey. The platform slows the moment between seeing and speaking by placing a context card and a reflection cue before any response control.

8.2 Design decisions and the reasoning behind them

The original document records eight design decisions. Each is retained below with the reason it matters, and with a note on whether it was implemented in the first prototype or is proposed for the next build.

Table 10. Design decisions, rationale and status

Decision (as recorded)	Why it was made	Status
Warm colours: orange, gold and beige	Warmth signals welcome and lowers the emotional temperature of a space where students are asked to be vulnerable.	Implemented in prototype; retained in the design system.
Rounded tiles	Soft edges make the interface feel less institutional and less like a data table.	Implemented; retained.
Simple layout	Cognitive load is a barrier for younger, multilingual and low-vision users.	Implemented; to be tested with users.
Icons instead of photographs to avoid copyright issues	Avoids using other people's images without permission and keeps the prototype legally clean.	Implemented as placeholders; the live wall uses author-supplied images with consent.
Audio players	Voice carries tone and personality, and the empathy work found audio helped people feel connected.	Implemented with placeholder audio; transcripts proposed.
Pop-up story windows	Keeps the visitor's place on the wall and prevents clutter.	Implemented; close control added after testing.
Grid layout like a cultural mural	Signals collection and curation rather than an algorithmic stream.	Implemented; retained.
Soft, non-corporate visual identity	Distinguishes the wall from school software and from social media.	Implemented; extended with the report's colour and type system.

Two decisions were changed as a result of testing and deserve separate explanation. The tiles were made larger, because testers found the original grid dense and the text small. The colour contrast was improved, because the warm palette had produced combinations that looked pleasant but were hard to read. Both changes show the value of testing: neither problem was visible to the designer, who had learned to read their own interface.

The colour system in this report extends the prototype's palette with a contrast check. Terracotta (#B85C3B) is used for headings and accents on cream, not for body text at small sizes. Teal (#2F6E68) marks safety and learning content. Ink (#2E2420) is used for body text on cream (#FBF4E8), a combination that exceeds the WCAG 2.2 AA contrast requirement for normal text. Colour is never the only signal: categories carry labels as well as colours, and status messages use words as well as icons.

8.3 Accessibility and ease of use

Accessibility was not a separate feature in the original prototype; it is a set of decisions that run through the interface. The Australian Human Rights Commission identifies the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2 as the current international standard and recommends conformance at Level AA as a minimum for digital services (AHRC, 2025). WCAG 2.2 adds criteria that matter for this project in particular: focus must not be obscured by sticky headers, dragging interactions must have a single-pointer alternative, and touch targets must be large enough to use (W3C Web Accessibility Initiative, 2023).

Table 11. Accessibility decisions and their current status

Barrier	Design response	Status
Low vision or colour blindness	High-contrast text, no colour-only meaning, scalable text, visible focus rings.	Partly implemented; audit planned.
Blind or screen-reader users	Semantic headings, alt text for every image, labelled controls, transcript for every audio tile.	Proposed; requires build and testing.
Motor or touch difficulties	Large touch targets, keyboard-operable tiles and pop-ups, no drag-only interaction.	Partly implemented; audit planned.
Cognitive load or low literacy	Plain language, one action per screen, prompts instead of a blank box, optional read-aloud.	Proposed; requires user testing.
Language background	Short sentences, a glossary for culture-specific terms, translation plan for key interface text.	Proposed; translation not yet started.
Slow connection or old device	Compressed images, audio-only option, no autoplay video, works without JavaScript for core reading.	Proposed; performance budget set.
Motion sensitivity	Respect reduced-motion settings; no parallax or autoplaying animation.	Proposed.

The table is deliberately candid about what is not yet built. An accessibility claim that has not been tested with assistive technology is a design intention, not a feature. The testing plan in Section 9 includes a screen-reader and keyboard session, and the website build will treat the WCAG 2.2 AA checklist as a release criterion rather than a nice-to-have.

8.4 What the prototype does not yet do

The first prototype is a front-end demonstration. It does not have a real database, user accounts, persistent moderation records or server-side content filtering. The bad-word filter is a client-side demonstration, which means it can be bypassed and should not be described as a security control. The moderator queue is a simulated view. These limitations are normal at this stage, but they matter for how the project is presented: the prototype demonstrates a concept and a flow, not a working safe platform. The website built after this report will make a further set of interactions real, while still using simulated moderation and demonstration content.

9. Testing and Evaluation

The original document records a testing stage and a set of improvements. This section preserves that record, examines what it does and does not support, and sets out a more rigorous plan for the next round. The distinction matters: the project's credibility depends on not claiming more evidence than it has.

9.1 Who tested the prototype

The original document lists four groups: students from cultural backgrounds, teachers, friends and family, and younger students who tested how simple the interface was. That is a sensible spread for an early prototype. It includes the primary users, the adults who would supervise them, and a group who would stress-test the clarity of the design.

The document does not record how many people took part in each group, how they were recruited, what they were asked to do, or how their feedback was captured. Only one tester, Arnold, is named and quoted. The other feedback is summarised as "people asked for" rather than attributed. This is a significant limitation. It means the project can say that testing happened and that it produced changes, but it cannot say how representative the feedback was or whether the changes worked for anyone other than the people who suggested them.

The honest summary is: the prototype was tested informally with a small, mixed group; one tester's comments were recorded verbatim; several requests were made by unnamed testers; and the design was revised in response. That is a normal starting point for a student project. It is not enough to support claims about effectiveness, and this report does not make them.

9.2 What Arnold said

The original document records the following comments under the heading "Feedback Collected – Arnold". They are reproduced verbatim because the exact wording matters more than a paraphrase.

> *"The tiles look friendly and colourful."*
>
> *"I like the greetings."*
>
> *"The upload form is easy to use."*
>
> *"The moderation system makes me feel safe."*

Arnold also asked for more categories, a search bar and a map view. These are specific, actionable requests, and they are more useful than a general rating. The first two were implemented in the next iteration. The map was deferred for the reasons set out in Section 6.3: it is technically harder, it raises questions about how cultures are located, and it needs an accessible alternative.

It is worth noticing what Arnold's feedback does not tell us. It does not tell us whether the wall would feel safe to a student who had previously been bullied, whether the audio greetings were understandable to someone outside the culture, or whether the interface worked for a student with a vision impairment. Those questions require different methods and different participants. A single friendly tester is a good start, not a validation.

9.3 Improvements made and why they matter

The original document lists eight improvements: added categories, a stronger bad-word filter, improved colour contrast, placeholder images and audio, larger tiles, hover animations, a report button and a close button for the pop-up. The table below connects each change to the feedback or observation that prompted it, and states its current status.

Table 12. Improvements made after the first test

Improvement	What prompted it	Why it matters	Status
Added categories	Testers asked for more categories; the original six felt limiting.	Categories are the main way a visitor finds a story, and they signal that everyday culture is welcome.	Implemented; six categories retained.
Stronger bad-word filter	Concern about offensive language reaching the wall.	Raises the cost of casual abuse, but cannot understand context; it must sit beside human review.	Prototype only; server-side filtering proposed.
Improved colour contrast	Text was hard to read on some warm backgrounds.	Accessibility and comfort; warm palettes often fail contrast checks.	Implemented; further audit planned.
Placeholder images and audio	The prototype needed content to feel real.	Makes the flow testable without using other people's cultural material.	Implemented; demonstration content only.
Larger tiles	The grid felt dense and text was small.	Improves readability and touch accuracy, especially for younger users.	Implemented.
Hover animations	The wall felt static.	Signals interactivity, but must respect reduced-motion settings.	Implemented; motion review planned.
Report button	Users wanted a way to act on harmful content.	A report control is a promise that someone will respond; it needs a workflow behind it.	Visible in prototype; workflow proposed.
Close button on pop-up	Users felt trapped in the story view.	Basic usability and a dignity issue for users who become distressed.	Implemented.

Two of these improvements are more significant than the others. The report button changes the platform's social contract: it tells users that harmful content is not their responsibility to tolerate. The close button looks minor but is an accessibility and safeguarding issue; a user who cannot exit a story may feel trapped. Both are examples of small interface decisions with ethical weight.

9.4 The testing cycle

The original document describes the cycle as: "I made a prototype tested it improved it tested it again and then made the version." This is the right shape for a Design Thinking process, and it is visible in the changes above. The second test is not documented in detail, so the report treats the cycle as one documented round plus a refinement, rather than two independently evidenced rounds. That is a weaker claim, and it is the accurate one.

9.5 The next testing plan

The next phase should test three things that the first round could not: whether the interface is usable without help, whether the Culture Bridge produces more respectful responses than an open comment box, and whether the wall is accessible to users with assistive technology. The plan below is proposed and has not yet been run. It assumes a small sample, teacher supervision and written consent.

Table 13. Planned testing sessions

Session	Participants	Tasks	Data collected	What would count as a positive signal
A. Usability	5-8 students aged 12-16, including at least two who have not seen the prototype.	Find a story in a named category; open it; find the context card; submit a practice story to a sandbox.	Task success, time on task, think-aloud notes, post-task difficulty rating.	Most participants complete the core tasks without help; no critical errors; difficulty ratings at or below the midpoint.
B. Safety and response quality	2 groups of 4-6 students, one using an open comment box and one using the Culture Bridge.	Read the same three stories and respond as they normally would; then rate how safe and respectful the space felt.	Comment quality against a rubric, perceived-safety ratings, short interviews.	Bridge responses include more questions and fewer judgements; higher perceived safety; no increase in reported discomfort.
C. Accessibility	2-3 students or adults who use a screen reader, keyboard or magnification.	Navigate the wall, open a story, play audio, submit a form.	Barrier log, WCAG 2.2 AA checklist results, participant commentary.	All core tasks are completable; no blocking barriers; fixes identified and prioritised.

The sessions should be run with a teacher present, in a quiet space, with a clear explanation that the participant can stop at any time. Practice stories should be fictional and should not ask students to share personal cultural material with the research team. Responses should be anonymised before analysis. If a participant becomes upset, the session should stop and the school's wellbeing process should take over. These safeguards are not bureaucratic; they are the difference between testing a design and exposing young people to the same harms the design is meant to prevent.

The evaluation questions for the next round are deliberately narrow: Can a first-time user find and understand a story? Does the context card change what a visitor notices? Do the response prompts produce more respectful language than an open box? Does the interface work with a screen reader? What makes a student decide not to submit? Each question has a method and a data source. None of them requires a large sample to produce a useful answer.

10. Safety, Ethics and Accessibility

Safety is the project's first design criterion, and it is the one most easily overstated. No platform can guarantee that a young person will not be harmed. What a platform can do is reduce the likelihood of harm, shorten its duration, support the person affected, and learn from what happened. This section sets out the measures the project would need before it could be used by real students, and it is explicit about the limits of each one.

10.1 A layered safety model

The project uses four layers rather than a single filter. This is consistent with eSafety's Safety by Design guidance, which argues that safety should be built into a service from the outset rather than added after harm occurs (eSafety Commissioner, n.d.). Prevention includes community rules, response prompts, no direct messages and no public popularity metrics. Detection includes automated checks, user reporting and moderator review. Response includes hiding content, contacting the author, supporting the person affected and escalating to the school when necessary. Learning includes reviewing reports for patterns and changing the rules when they are not working. The layers are shown in Figure 4.

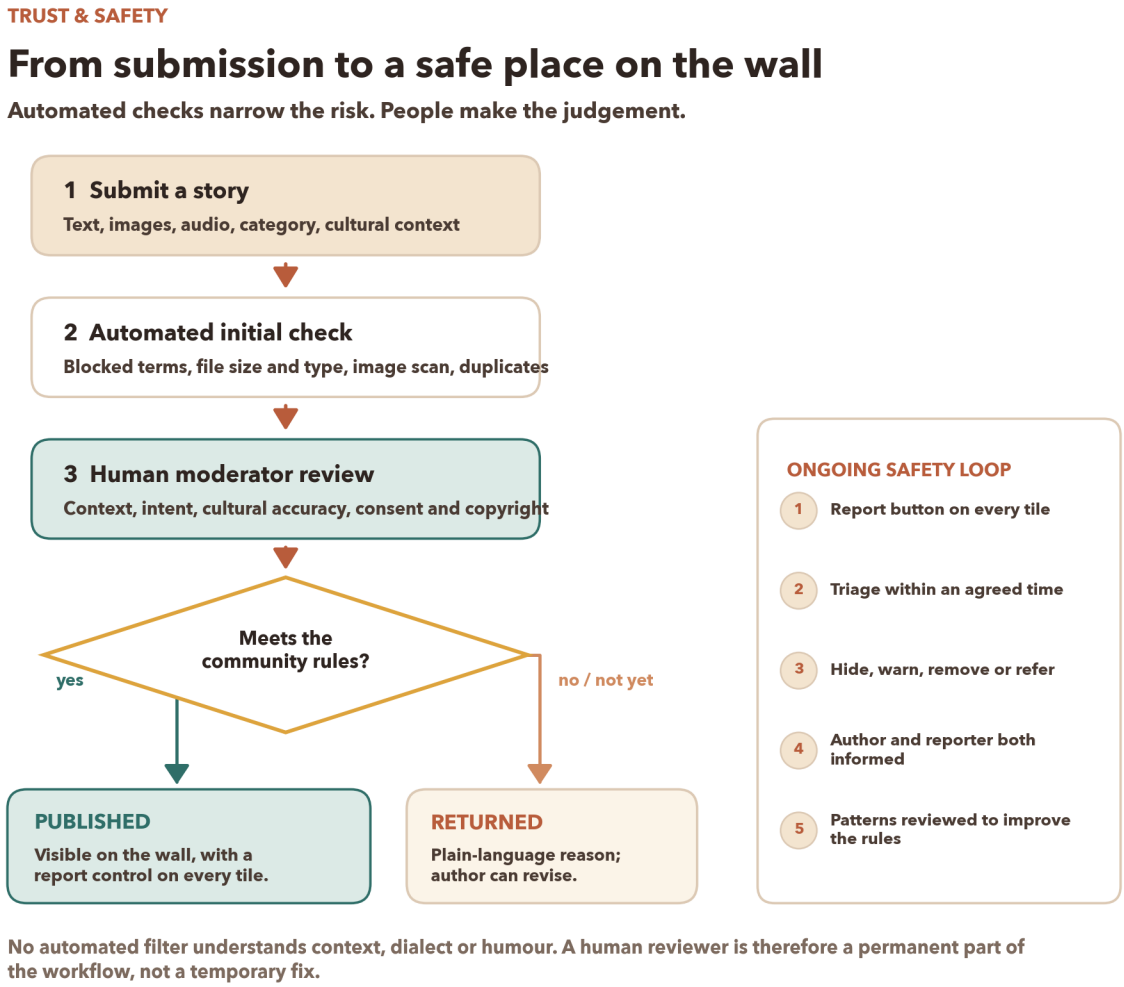


Figure 4. The intended submission and moderation workflow. Automated checks narrow the risk, but a human moderator makes the decision. The ongoing loop on the right is what turns individual reports into better rules.

The workflow is deliberately unglamorous. A story is submitted, checked automatically, reviewed by a person, and either published or returned with a reason. Published stories keep a report control. Reports

enter a triage queue, are reviewed within an agreed time, and result in action that is communicated to the reporter and the author. Each decision is logged so that patterns can be reviewed. None of this is innovative; it is the minimum for a space that invites young people to be vulnerable.

10.2 Automated checks and their limits

Automated checks are useful for clear, mechanical problems: file type and size, duplicate uploads, known slurs, links to external sites, and images that match a known harmful hash. They are poor at meaning. New America's analysis of content moderation explains that hate speech is especially difficult to detect automatically because meaning depends on context, community and region, and because training data is uneven across languages and dialects (New America, 2019). A word that is a slur in one context may be reclaimed in another; a sentence that looks threatening to a classifier may be a quotation in a history project; a joke between friends may be cruel to a bystander.

The practical consequence is that automated checks should be a first pass, not a gatekeeper. They should err towards sending content to a human rather than silently removing it, and they should never be the only reason a student's story is rejected. A false positive is not a neutral error: it tells a student that their own culture is suspicious. The interface should explain what happened, offer an appeal, and let a moderator override the filter. The filter's rules should be documented and reviewed, not hidden.

10.3 Human moderation

Human moderation is the core of the model, and it is also the project's biggest operational risk. A moderator needs training in the community rules, cultural humility, safeguarding and the school's escalation process. They need time — realistically, a queue of 20 stories can take an hour to review carefully — and they need support when content is distressing. A single teacher moderating alone is not a sustainable model. The project proposes a small panel of at least two adults, including at least one person with relevant cultural knowledge or a clear process for consulting someone who does.

Moderators should ask a consistent set of questions. Is this the author's own story, or are they speaking for others? Is the cultural detail specific and accurate enough to be fair? Is there consent from the people shown or recorded? Is the tone respectful towards the people described? Does the story contain personal information that could identify someone? Would publishing it expose the author to harm? A checklist does not make the decision objective, but it makes it more consistent and easier to explain.

Moderators also need authority to act quickly. A reported story should be hideable before review is complete, with the author informed that this is a temporary safety measure rather than a judgement. Decisions should be recorded with a reason, and a second moderator should be able to review a contested case. This is ordinary moderation practice, and it is the difference between a report button that means something and one that is decorative.

10.4 Reporting and response

The report control should be visible on every tile, reachable by keyboard, and usable without writing an explanation, although an optional note should be offered. Reporting should be private: the author should not be told who reported them, and the reporter should not be exposed to the author. The reporter should receive an acknowledgement and, where appropriate, an outcome. A report that disappears into a queue teaches users that reporting is pointless.

Some reports are safeguarding matters rather than moderation matters. A disclosure of abuse, threats of violence, or content suggesting a student is at risk should leave the moderation queue and go to the school's

designated safeguarding lead immediately. Moderators should not attempt to counsel a student or investigate a disclosure themselves. The platform should make this escalation path obvious in the moderator interface, with a single action that records the time and the person notified.

10.5 Privacy and consent

The platform should collect as little personal information as possible. A student should be able to use a pseudonym; a display name should not be required to be a legal name; email addresses should not be visible to other users; and there should be no public profile, follower list or direct messaging. Uploads should be stored with access controls, and the retention period should be stated. These choices reduce the platform's value as a target and make the safety promise easier to keep.

Consent needs to be specific. A student sharing a story is consenting to that story being published on the wall, not to it being used in marketing, research or a competition presentation. Images and audio raise a second layer: the people in a photograph or on a recording have their own rights. A student should confirm that everyone identifiable has agreed, and the platform should make it easy to blur faces or choose an illustration instead. For users under 18, the school's policy on publishing student work and images should be followed, including parent or caregiver consent where required.

Australian privacy law, including the Privacy Act 1988 (Cth) and the Australian Privacy Principles, sets baseline expectations for handling personal information. The project does not claim legal compliance it has not verified. Before a pilot, the school's privacy officer or leadership team should review the data flow: what is collected, where it is stored, who can see it, how long it is kept and how it is deleted. A short privacy notice written for students, not lawyers, should be available before the first upload.

10.6 Copyright, cultural ownership and First Nations protocols

Every story, image and recording belongs to someone. A student can share their own work, work they have permission to use, or work under a licence that allows reuse. The platform should ask for a simple declaration at upload, display attribution where required, and provide a takedown route for anyone whose work appears without permission. Using other people's photographs to illustrate a culture is not a neutral act; it can misrepresent the people in them and strip away context.

Cultural ownership is broader than copyright. Indigenous Cultural and Intellectual Property (ICIP) recognises that some knowledge, designs, songs and stories are collectively owned and subject to protocols that individual copyright law does not capture. Australia has hundreds of distinct First Nations cultures and language groups, and treating them as a single "Indigenous" category would repeat the flattening the project is trying to avoid. A story about Country, ceremony or design should only be shared with the authority of the community it comes from, and some knowledge should not be published at all.

The project's approach is therefore to link to community-authorised sources rather than to reproduce cultural material without permission, to consult local Elders or Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander education staff before including First Nations content, and to follow the Australian Curriculum's Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Histories and Cultures cross-curriculum priority as a guide to respectful practice rather than as a substitute for local protocols (ACARA, 2022). The platform should also make it easy for a community to ask for a story to be removed, without requiring them to justify the request publicly.

10.7 Accessibility as a safety issue

Accessibility is often treated as a compliance task. For this project it is a safety issue. A student who cannot read the report button, cannot hear the audio, cannot navigate the pop-up with a keyboard or cannot

understand the language of the interface is excluded from the protection the platform claims to offer. The target is WCAG 2.2 Level AA (AHRC, 2025; W3C WAI, 2023), with additional attention to cognitive accessibility and language because the audience includes younger students and students learning in a second language.

Practical measures include: alt text for every image, written by the author with guidance; transcripts for every audio tile; captions for any video; visible focus states; a logical tab order; large touch targets; text that can be resized to 200 per cent without loss of content; no colour-only meaning; plain-language labels; a reduced-motion setting; and a low-bandwidth mode that loads text and audio before images. The interface should be tested with a screen reader and with keyboard-only navigation before it is shown to students, not after.

The project should also avoid assuming that every student has a fast connection, a recent device or a quiet place to record audio. An audio-first design can exclude students who do not want their voice recorded or who share a room with family. Audio should therefore be optional, and the wall should be fully usable in text. That is both an accessibility decision and a participation decision.

10.8 What must exist before real students use the platform

The following conditions are the minimum for a supervised pilot. They are stated as requirements rather than aspirations because each one protects a real person.

- A named moderation panel of at least two trained adults, with a rota and a backup.
- A written community agreement, reviewed by the school, in plain language for students.
- A privacy notice and consent process, including parent or caregiver consent where required.
- A safeguarding escalation path agreed with the school's designated lead.
- A takedown and appeal process, with response times and a record of decisions.
- Security review of uploads, storage and account access; no public profile or messaging.
- Accessibility testing with assistive technology and fixes for blocking issues.
- A content plan for the first term, so the wall is not empty on launch.
- A named teacher or community lead responsible for the pilot, with time allocated.
- An evaluation plan approved before data collection begins.

This list is long, and that is the point. A platform that invites young people to share their culture is asking for trust. Trust is earned by having the boring systems in place before the invitation is made.

11. Implementation Plan

The project has a fixed external deadline: the Peacebuilding National Youth Design Challenge closes in early November 2026 (YCA, 2026a). That date shapes the plan. The report and the interactive website are the submission; structured testing with students and a school pilot come after submission, because they require consent and supervision that cannot be arranged responsibly in the remaining weeks. The plan is therefore staged, with the competition deliverables on the critical path and the validation work sequenced behind them.

Table 14. Staged implementation plan

Stage	Timing	Key deliverables	Dependencies	Main risks	Completion criteria
1. Complete and review the report	October 2026	This report; diagrams; reference list; internal review against the challenge brief.	Original document; research; design decisions.	Overstating evidence; inconsistent terminology.	Report saved as DOCX and PDF; every claim labelled; all figures legible in print.
2. Build the interactive website prototype	October - early November 2026	Home, wall, search and filters, story view, Culture Bridge, submission and preview, safety pages, project and impact pages, moderation demo.	Design system; demonstration content; hosting.	Scope creep; accessibility regressions; time.	Core journeys work on desktop and mobile; keyboard navigation; no blocking accessibility issues.
3. Test with permission and supervision	November - December 2026	Usability session (5-8 students); safety/response comparison; accessibility session.	Consent; teacher supervision; test materials.	Participant distress; small sample; scheduling.	Sessions completed; notes anonymised; findings written up with limitations.
4. Improve the website	December 2026 - January 2027	Fixes prioritised by severity; revised prompts; accessibility fixes; performance improvements.	Stage 3 findings; developer time.	Fixing symptoms rather than causes.	Blocking issues resolved; changes traced to evidence; regression check completed.
5. Prepare the competition presentation	Late October - early November 2026	Pitch, demonstration script, judge Q&A, one-page summary, logo and solution image.	Stage 2 demo; report.	Demo failure on the day; overlong pitch.	Five-minute pitch rehearsed; offline backup; demo runs without a live server.
6. Explore a school or community pilot	Term 1 2027	Pilot proposal; moderation plan; privacy and consent pack; content calendar; evaluation plan.	School approval; moderation panel; hosting and support.	No moderator capacity; low participation; safeguarding incident.	Pilot approved with named responsibilities; baseline data collected; review scheduled.

The critical path runs through Stage 2. If the website is not ready, there is no demonstration; if the demonstration is not ready, the pitch has nothing to show. The report therefore prioritises a small number of complete journeys over a large number of half-built pages. A judge is more convinced by a working submission flow and a clear moderation demonstration than by a site map with twelve empty sections.

Stage 3 is deliberately after the competition deadline. It would be possible to run a quick usability test before submission, and the project may do so if a teacher can supervise it and consent can be arranged. It would not be responsible to run a safety test with students in the final weeks, because a safety test requires a response plan for distress. The report says this plainly rather than implying that testing has already happened.

12. Impact and Success Measures

A website cannot solve racism, prejudice or bullying. It can change what a small group of people do in a particular setting, and it can make a particular kind of conversation easier to have. The project's impact framework is built around that modest claim. It distinguishes activities (what the project does), outputs (what participants receive), short-term outcomes (what might change for participants) and longer-term outcomes (what might change in a school or community), and it identifies how each would be measured.

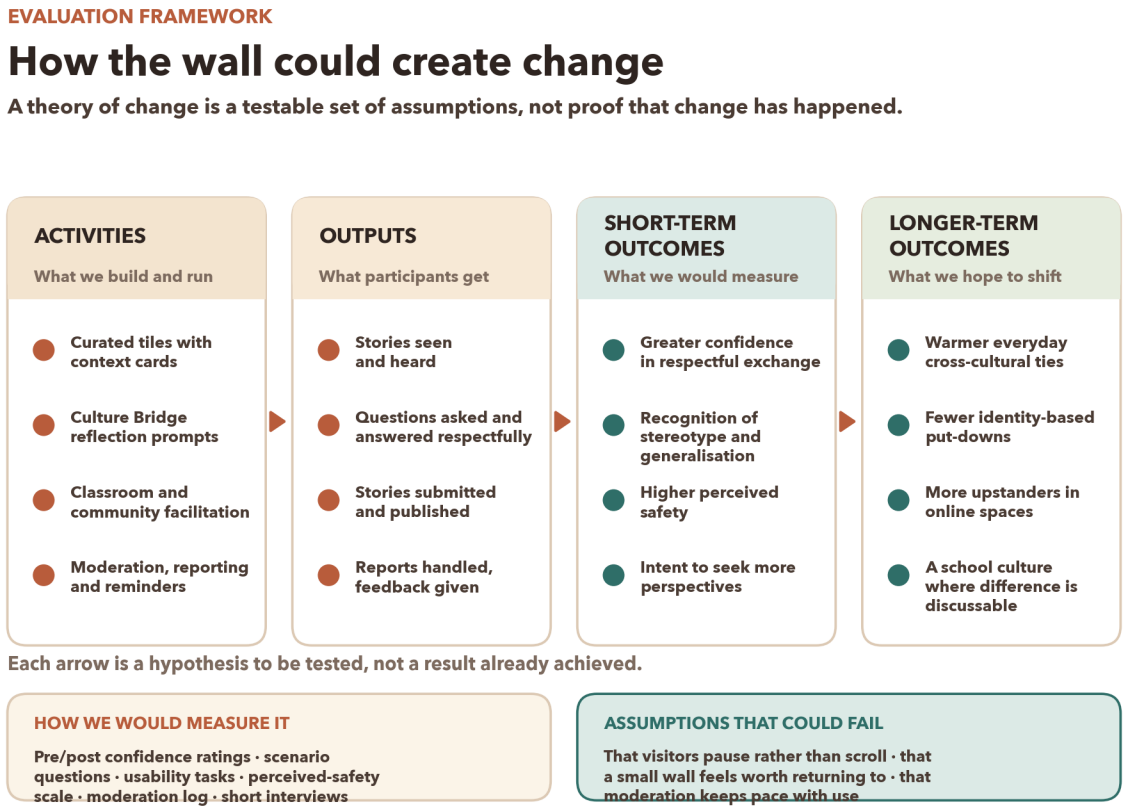


Figure 5. The project's theory of change. Each arrow is a hypothesis. The bottom band names the assumptions that could fail and the methods that would be used to test them.

The framework follows the logic recommended by the Centre for Social Impact's Roadmap to Social Impact, which sets out a sequence from defining the issue and designing the response to choosing outcomes, indicators and data collection methods, with attention to lived experience, equity, ethics and cultural safety (Centre for Social Impact [CSI], 2025). For a project of this size, the most useful part of that guidance is its insistence on mixed methods and on distinguishing what a project delivered from what changed.

Table 15. Impact indicators and how they would be measured

Outcome area	Indicator	Method	Timing	Status
Confidence in respectful intercultural communication	Self-rated confidence in asking a respectful question about another culture; quality of written response against a rubric.	Pre/post rating plus a short scenario task; rubric scored by two reviewers.	Before and after a 3-week classroom use.	Planned
Recognition of stereotypes and generalisations	Ability to identify a generalisation in a short story and explain why it is limited.	Scenario questions with open responses, coded for reasoning.	During and after use.	Planned
Perceived safety	Self-rated safety and comfort when reading and responding; number of participants who would post again.	5-point scale plus interviews; report and moderation log.	After each session.	Planned
Usability	Task success rate, time on task, critical errors.	Moderated usability test with 5-8 participants.	Stage 3.	Planned
Quality of user feedback	Proportion of responses that add a question, context or reflection rather than a judgement.	Comment rubric applied to a sample; inter-rater check.	Stage 3 and pilot.	Planned
Participation and reach	Number of active users; number of published stories; number of returning users.	Platform analytics, aggregate and non-identifying.	Pilot.	Not yet available
Moderation performance	Reports acknowledged within target; median time to decision; proportion of decisions overturned on appeal.	Moderation log audit.	Pilot.	Not yet available
Teacher judgement	Teacher's assessment of whether the wall supported curriculum outcomes and was manageable to supervise.	Short interview and written reflection.	End of pilot.	Planned

No baseline figures are claimed, because none have been collected. No target percentages are set, because a target invented before a baseline would be arbitrary. The honest approach is to collect a baseline in the first session and agree with the teacher what a meaningful change would look like for that group. If the project later reports a change, it should report the measure, the sample and the limitations alongside it.

Attribution is the hardest part. If students become more confident over three weeks, the wall is only one possible cause: a teacher, a class discussion, a film or a friendship may matter more. The evaluation is therefore designed to describe contribution rather than prove causation. Interviews should ask students what they think changed and why; teachers should be asked what else was happening; and the report should present the findings as a plausible account, not a verdict.

13. Limitations and Risk Management

The project's limitations are substantial, and naming them is part of designing responsibly. The table below lists the main risks, their likely impact, and a practical mitigation. The mitigations are not guarantees; they are the actions that would reduce the risk to a level the project can defend.

Table 16. Risk register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Thin testing evidence (one named tester; unclear sample)	High	Medium	Label evidence accurately; run the planned Stage 3 sessions; report sample sizes and limitations.
Moderation workload exceeds capacity	High	High	Start with one class or year group; cap submissions per week; recruit at least two moderators; publish response times.
Harmful content reaches the wall	Medium	High	Automated pre-check plus human review; hide-on-report; clear escalation; post-incident review.
Privacy breach or unwanted exposure	Medium	High	Data minimisation; pseudonyms; no messaging; access controls; retention limits; school privacy review.
Cultural misrepresentation or offence	Medium	High	Author-written context; cultural advisers; community takedown route; specific rather than general claims.
Accessibility barriers exclude users	Medium	High	WCAG 2.2 AA target; assistive-technology testing; plain language; transcripts and alt text; low-bandwidth mode.
Low participation makes the wall look empty	Medium	Medium	Seed with classroom content; curriculum-based use; term calendar; do not launch publicly before content exists.
Difficulty measuring attitude change	High	Medium	Use mixed methods; measure proximal outcomes (confidence, recognition, response quality); describe contribution, not causation.
Technical limits of a prototype (no backend, simulated moderation)	High	Medium	State clearly what is simulated; build the demo to work offline; plan a real backend before any pilot.
Scope creep and missed deadline	Medium	High	Prioritise complete core journeys; freeze features two weeks before submission; rehearse the demo.

Three limitations deserve more than a row in a table. The first is evidence. The project's empathy and testing work is thin, and no amount of careful writing can turn one quoted tester into a representative sample. The report's response is transparency plus a credible plan for better evidence, not embellishment.

The second is moderation. A platform that depends on human review is only as safe as the people doing it, and schools are already stretched. The project should not launch to a whole school before it has a moderation rota, a response-time commitment and a backup. If those cannot be secured, a single-class pilot is the responsible scale.

The third is measurement. Attitudes are slow, context-dependent and hard to attribute to a single intervention. The project can measure whether students felt safer, whether their responses became more respectful and whether they could recognise a generalisation. It cannot credibly claim to have reduced racism in a school after three weeks. Saying so does not weaken the project; it shows that the designer understands the difference between a good intention and a demonstrated outcome.

13.1 Conditions for pausing or stopping

A project that invites young people to share their culture should have a clear answer to the question: under what conditions would we stop? The following conditions are proposed as stop signals. They are not a sign of failure; they are the governance that makes the project safe to attempt.

- No second trained moderator is available, or the moderation rota cannot cover a school week.
- The school has not reviewed the privacy notice, consent process and data storage arrangements.
- A blocking accessibility issue remains unresolved for a core task such as reading a story or reporting content.
- A serious harm incident occurs and the agreed response and escalation path is not followed.
- The supervising teacher cannot commit the time to review submissions within the published response time.

13.2 Signals that would justify continuing

The reverse is also worth stating. The project should continue, and perhaps grow, if the evidence shows that students return without being prompted, that responses become more respectful over time, that moderators can keep pace, and that teachers are willing to use the wall again in another term. Those are modest signals, but they are observable, and they matter more than a large launch.

14. Conclusion

Culture Swap Wall began with a simple observation: young people have cultural stories worth sharing, and the places where they might share them are often the places where those stories are mocked. The original Design Thinking work recorded that fear clearly, along with the related problems of stereotyping, misunderstanding and not knowing how to speak about culture respectfully. This report has kept that problem at the centre while strengthening the evidence around it, sharpening the design question and developing the response.

The design that has emerged is deliberately modest. It is a curated wall, not a network. It uses tiles, context cards and audio to make culture specific and human. It replaces the open comment box with a structured sequence — Discover, Understand, Connect — that asks a visitor to pause before speaking. It puts human moderation and a visible report control at the centre of the experience rather than at the edges. And it treats accessibility, privacy and cultural ownership as design requirements rather than add-ons.

The project has achieved a coherent concept, a first prototype, a documented round of feedback and a substantial redesign of the interaction model. It has not yet achieved a tested, safe, live platform. The next steps are concrete: build the interactive website, test it with students under supervision, fix what fails, and only then consider a small pilot. The evaluation framework in this report is designed to make that process honest, including the possibility that the Culture Bridge does not produce the effects the project hopes for.

That possibility is not a reason to stop. Peacebuilding at the scale of a school is not a grand gesture; it is a series of small decisions about how people speak to one another. A wall that makes one of those decisions easier — that turns a stare into a question, or a joke into a story — is worth testing. The project's contribution is to design that moment carefully, and to be honest about what it has and has not yet shown.

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Note on secondary citations. Two statistics in this report are attributed to sources cited in the challenge brief rather than to the original publications: the eSafety Commission (2023) figure on bullying and the Scanlon Foundation (2023) figure on witnessed unfair treatment. They are cited in the text as "as cited in Young Change Agents, 2026a" and are not listed separately here, in line with APA guidance on secondary sources.

Appendix A — Design Thinking Evidence Trail

The table below maps each element of the original document to the section of this report where it was developed, and states its evidence status. It is intended to make the relationship between the original student work and the completed report visible to a judge.

Table A1. Mapping from the original document to this report

Original element	Where it appears	What changed	Status
Client table (requirements, audience, tone, competitors)	Section 2	Restated as seven objectives with evaluation methods; client name corrected.	Preserved and expanded
Empathy methods and insights	Section 4	Organised by user group; limitations stated; ethical plan added.	Preserved, with limits
User needs and challenges	Sections 4-5	Linked to design responses and criteria.	Preserved and expanded
Problem statement	Section 3.5	Developed into a user-centred statement and a design question.	Preserved and sharpened
Crazy 8s, mind maps, HMW questions	Section 6	Purpose explained; one HMW question critiqued and reframed.	Preserved
Fourteen generated ideas	Sections 6.2-6.3	Grouped by purpose; selection matrix added.	Preserved and evaluated
Six final features	Sections 6.3, 7	Explained as a system; two features added (Culture Bridge, response prompts).	Preserved and extended
Prototype features and design decisions	Section 8	Rationale explained; implementation status labelled.	Preserved and evaluated
Arnold's feedback	Section 9.2	Reproduced verbatim; significance and limits discussed.	Preserved
Improvements made	Section 9.3	Linked to feedback and to design reasoning.	Preserved
Testing cycle	Section 9.4	Described accurately as one documented round plus refinement.	Preserved, with limits
Final summary	Section 14	Rewritten to synthesise the completed work.	Developed

Appendix B — Requirements-to-Features Matrix

Figure 6 shows how each of the six primary user needs is addressed by the feature set, and how each response would be evaluated. Filled circles indicate a primary response; open circles indicate partial support; small dots indicate no direct relationship. The ratings are design judgements, not measured results.

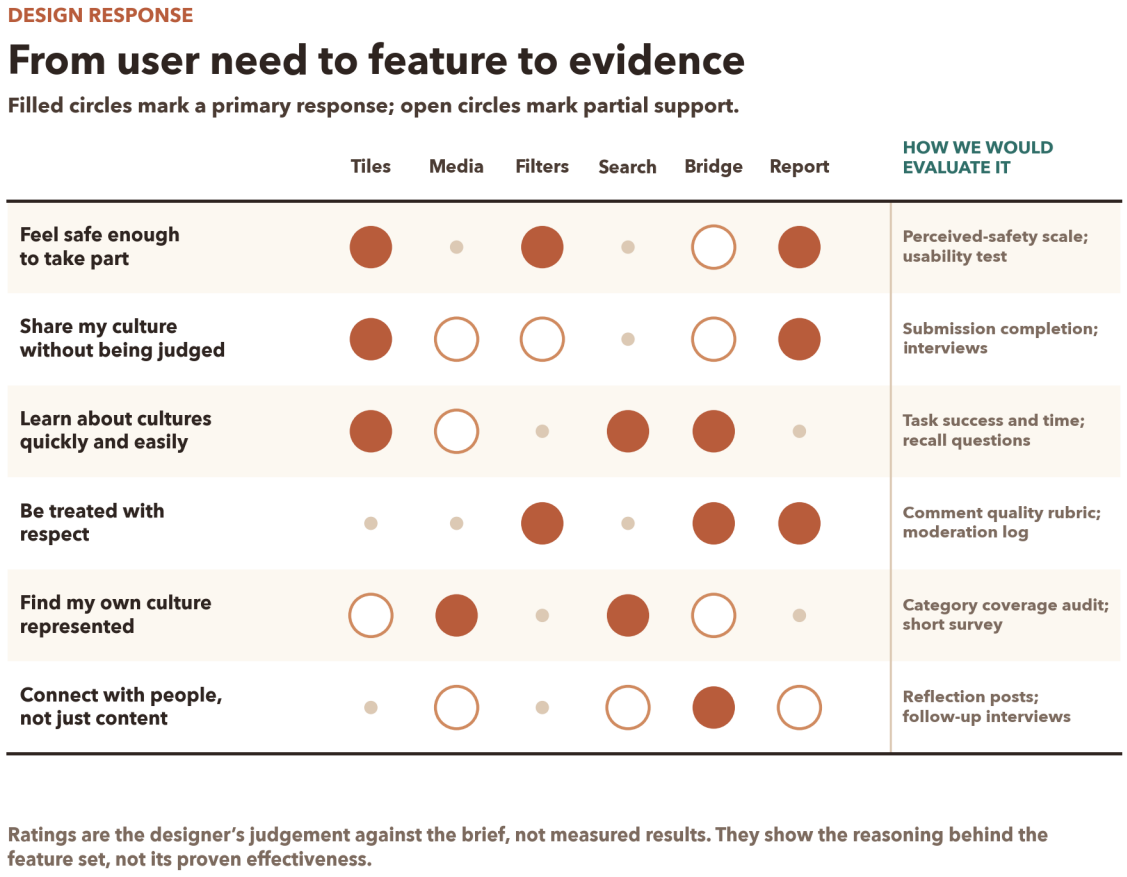


Figure 6. Requirements-to-features matrix. "Filters" includes automated checks and human moderation; "Media" includes image and audio with transcripts; "Bridge" is the Discover-Understand-Connect sequence.

The figure is a design summary, not an evaluation result. Section 12 sets out the full indicator plan, including the measures, timing and limitations for each outcome. The distinction matters: a matrix can show that a feature is intended to meet a need, but only a test with users can show whether it does.

Appendix C — Complete Ideation Record

The original document lists fourteen ideas. This appendix records what happened to each one, so that the selection process is auditable.

Table C1. Disposition of every idea generated

Idea	Purpose	Decision	Reason
Grid of culture tiles	Discovery	Build	Core unit; high on every criterion.
Audio greetings	Tone and connection	Build	Adds voice and reduces writing pressure; needs transcripts.
Food stories section	Story type	Build (within categories)	Food is a strong entry point; kept as a category, not a separate site.
Gallery for art and clothing	Story type	Build (within categories)	Images are central; clothing raises consent and cultural ownership issues.
Safe upload filters	Safety	Build	Necessary but insufficient; paired with human review.
Report button	Safety	Build	Core user safety control; needs a workflow behind it.
Moderator queue	Safety	Build	Essential for a supervised space.
Kindness reminder before posting	Safety and norms	Build	Low cost, high value; wording needs testing.
Pop-up stories	Discovery	Build	Keeps place on the wall; needs a visible close control.
Interactive map of cultures	Discovery	Defer to Phase 2	Hard to represent cultures and diaspora fairly; accessibility and technical cost.
Daily culture spotlight	Freshness	Defer to Phase 2	Depends on a content pipeline and moderation capacity.
Random culture generator	Discovery	Defer to Phase 2	Fun, but adds little until the wall has depth.
Audio player for cultural sounds	Tone	Build (as media player)	Merged into the tile's audio feature.
Celebration calendar	Freshness and relevance	Defer to Phase 2	Useful for classrooms; requires accurate, culturally specific dates and local review.

Appendix D — Testing Materials

D.1 Draft interview guide (empathy phase)

These questions are for a voluntary, supervised interview with a student who has consented. They are open, non-leading and designed to produce stories rather than ratings. The interviewer should follow up with "why?" and should not ask a student to speak for a whole culture.

10. Can you tell me about a time you shared something about your culture with other people? What happened?
11. What made it easy or hard to share?
12. What did you want people to understand about it?
13. What did you worry they might think?
14. Have you ever seen someone's culture made fun of online? What did you notice?
15. What would make you feel safe enough to post something on a wall like this?
16. What would you want to be able to remove or change later?
17. Who would you not want to see it, and why?

D.2 Consent outline

A plain-language consent note should explain: what the project is; what participation involves; that participation is voluntary; that the student can skip questions, stop at any time and withdraw before analysis; who will see the notes; how data will be stored and for how long; what will happen if the student discloses harm; and who to contact with a question or concern. For participants under 18, the school's policy on student research and parent or caregiver consent should be followed. Consent should be recorded, not assumed.

D.3 Comment-quality rubric (draft)

The rubric is used to compare responses produced with an open comment box and with the Culture Bridge. It is scored by two reviewers who do not know which condition produced the comment. Each response is scored from 0 to 2 on four dimensions.

Table D1. Draft rubric for respectful response quality

Dimension	0	1	2
Relevance to the story	Unrelated or generic	Mentions the topic but not the story	Refers to a specific detail and its meaning
Respect and tone	Dismissive, mocking or hostile	Neutral but flat	Warm, curious and respectful
Perspective-taking	Assumes or generalises	Acknowledges difference without exploring it	Shows awareness of the author's perspective or the limits of the reviewer's own
Invitation to dialogue	Closes the conversation	Adds a comment but no opening	Asks a genuine question or offers a related reflection

Appendix E — Original Prototype Evidence

The image below is reproduced from the original document. It shows an early front-end concept under the working title "CultureShare", with a navigation bar, a hero section, featured story cards and a story detail view with comments. It is included as evidence of the prototype's early state, not as a representation of the final design.

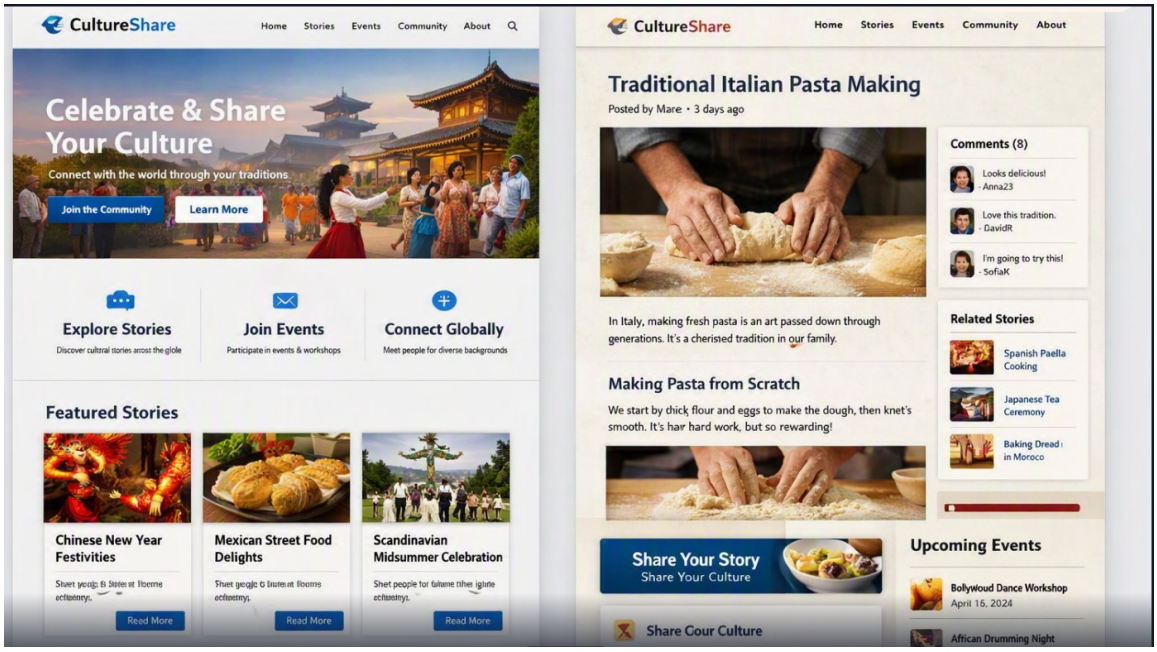


Figure 7. Early prototype as supplied in the original document (working title "CultureShare"). The navigation, hero section, story cards and comment area show the concept before the safety model was designed. The report standardises the project name to Culture Swap Wall.

Two things are worth noting for the record. First, the prototype used a comment area, which the current design replaces with the Culture Bridge because an open comment box invites exactly the kind of response the project is trying to prevent. Second, the prototype's working title differs from the project name. This is a normal artefact of early design work, but a competition submission should be consistent. The screenshot is retained unaltered so that the evidence remains accurate.

Appendix F — Submission Readiness Checklist

This checklist is for the final submission. It separates what is complete from what still needs to be confirmed. It is included because competition entries are often lost to administrative gaps rather than weak ideas.

Table F1. Submission readiness

Item	Owner	Status	Notes
Completed project report (DOCX and PDF)	Student	Complete	Saved as separate files; original document unchanged.
Diagrams embedded and legible in print	Student	Complete	Seven figures (six diagrams and one prototype screenshot), numbered and captioned.
Reference list checked	Student	Complete	APA 7; URLs checked October 2026.
Project name used consistently	Student	Complete	Culture Swap Wall throughout; original screenshot labelled.
School name, year level and teacher details	Student / teacher	To confirm	Not included in this report to avoid inventing details.
Competition project page fields	Student / teacher	To confirm	Check the current requirements in the challenge resources.
Logo and one image of the solution	Student	In progress	Required by the challenge submission.
Consent for images, audio and student work	Teacher	Not started	Needed before any real student content is published.
Named moderation panel and rota	Teacher	Not started	Needed before a pilot.
Privacy notice and data flow review	School	Not started	Needed before any upload by a student.
Accessibility check (WCAG 2.2 AA)	Student	In progress	Keyboard and screen-reader checks planned.
Working demonstration and offline backup	Student	In progress	Website build follows this report.
Five-minute pitch and judge Q&A	Student	Not started	Prepare after the website demo is stable.
Pilot proposal and evaluation plan	Student / teacher	Draft	Outline in Sections 11 and 12.

The distinction between "complete" and "to confirm" matters. The report is finished and can be submitted as a design document. The platform is not yet ready for real students, and the checklist says so. That is the correct status for a project at this stage.